UCC 202 – DEVELOPMENT CONCEPTS & APPLICATION

LECTURE 3: CORE VALUES FOR DEVELOPMENT

- The core values of development provide the guiding principles that ensure progress is achieved in a manner that benefits all segments of society and sustains the welfare of future generations.
- These values prioritize fairness, inclusion, sustainability, and empowerment, shaping policies that aim for holistic and human-cantered development.
- When development policies align with the core values, they are more likely to lead to meaningful progress that benefits everyone in society, promoting long-term prosperity, social cohesion, and human well-being.

3.1. Equity

Equity emphasizes fairness in the distribution of economic and social benefits.

- Seeks to reduce disparities and ensure that marginalized groups, such as the poor, women, and minorities, have equal access to opportunities and resources.
- Addressing historical and structural disadvantages that prevent certain groups from participating fully in economic, political, and social life.

Examples

- Fair distribution of resources, ensuring that disadvantaged groups benefit from development.
- Progressive tax policies
- Income redistribution
- Access to basic services like education and healthcare.

3.2. Sustainability

- Sustainability in development ensures that economic growth and progress do not come at the expense of the environment by depleting resources or damaging the ability of future generations to meet their own needs.
- Sustainable development considers both the environmental and economic dimensions and promotes practices that balance human growth with the preservation of the planet.

Example:

- Protecting the environment and ensuring that development can be maintained for future generations.
- Promoting eco-tourism,

- Preserving of biodiversity
- Investing in renewable energy sources which support economic growth while protecting the environment.
- Creating resilient economies that can withstand global challenges, such as climate change or economic shocks

3.3. Freedom and Empowerment

- Enhancing people's abilities to make their own choices, access opportunities and lead fulfilling lives.
- Providing individuals with the tools, education, and resources to control their lives and contribute meaningfully to society.
- Democratic governance, participation in decision-making, and protection of human rights, ensuring that individuals can freely pursue their interests in an open and supportive society.

Example:

Microfinance programs empower communities by providing small loans that allow them to start businesses, gain financial independence, and improve their families' standard of living.

- Hustler Fund
- Women Empowerment Fund
- Uwezo Fund

3.4. Social Justice

- Ensuring fairness in the distribution of resources, opportunities, and benefits across society.
- Rectifying historical and systemic injustices and inequalities, such as those based on class, race, gender, or ethnicity
- Equal access to the opportunities and resources that are essential for development.
- Labour rights
    - Non-discrimination
    - Equal pay for equal work
    - Freedom from servitude- no work without compensation

Example:

Uplifting historically marginalized communities by providing quotas in education, government jobs, and political representation to promote social justice and equal opportunities.

- County women representatives

- Nominated members of parliament
- Affirmative action in education and employment opportunities

3.5. Human Dignity

- Inherent value of each individual, recognizing their right to live with respect, autonomy, and honour.
- Ensuring every individual is treated with respect, autonomy, and honour.
- Providing all people with the resources and opportunities to lead a dignified life that is free from exploitation and oppression.

Example:

- Citizen right to access to healthcare, education and employment rights which help maintain the dignity and well-being of individuals.
- Policies and laws aimed at eliminating exploitation and violation of human rights
    - Child labour
    - Human trafficking
    - Arbitrary arrest and detention

3.6. Solidarity

- Solidarity involves the recognition that individuals and nations are interconnected and should work together to promote the collective good.
- Fostering cooperation and mutual support to address global and local challenges.
- It encourages cooperation across borders, regions and groups to address common challenges:
    - Poverty
    - climate change
    - pandemics
- Encouraging community-based development initiatives where local communities take the lead in finding and implementing solutions

Example:

- International development aid to assist developing countries in building infrastructure, improving health systems, and reducing poverty.
- Chamas and SACCOS
- Trade unions
- Student councils

3.7. Participation and Inclusivity

- Importance of involving all members of society in the development process.
- People-cantered Development - individuals should actively participate in decision-making processes that affect their lives.
- Inclusivity ensures that no group, (particularly the marginalized or vulnerable) is left out of the development process.
- Ensuring that all social groups are heard and represented in national development plans.

Example:

- Participatory budgeting processes where local communities directly influence how government funds are allocated to improve public services.
- Gender equality
- Youth involvement
- Indigenous people's rights

Summary of Core Values for Development

a) **Equity**: Fair distribution of resources, ensuring that disadvantaged groups benefit from development.
b) **Sustainability**: Protecting the environment and ensuring that development can be maintained for future generations.
c) **Freedom and Empowerment**: Enhancing individuals' ability to make choices and lead fulfilling lives through access to opportunities.
d) **Social Justice:** Ensuring fairness in opportunities, addressing systemic inequalities, and promoting equal rights.
e) **Human Dignity:** Ensuring every individual is treated with respect, autonomy, and honour.
f) **Solidarity**: Fostering cooperation and mutual support to address global and local challenges.
g) **Participation and Inclusivity**: Involving all segments of society in the development process to ensure that no one is left behind.